dwellers'. Similarly, in the remarkable book on statesmanship and political economy known as the *Arthashastra*, written by the Brahmin Chanakya, who acted as counsellor to Emperor Ashoka's father and grandfather, these same Atavikas are described as 'living in their own territory, many in number and brave, who fight openly, seize and ruin countries, having the same characteristics as kings'. Formerly known as tribals, today we have come to recognise them as India's 'first people', to whom the term *adivasi* ('original people') was awarded by social reformers in the 1930s as an improvement on the politically loaded term *dalit*, meaning 'oppressed' or 'ground down' – a term first employed by the Maharashtrian political activist Jyotirao Phule in the 1880s but subsequently picked up and applied to greater effect by Dr B. R. Ambedkar.